

Re: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Saranac Lake Central School District, I am pleased to express our strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for the Lake Colby Beach House accessibility upgrades.

Lake Colby Beach is an invaluable community resource for our students and their families. Each summer, youth from across our district rely on the beach for recreation, swimming lessons, and outdoor activities that build lifelong skills and confidence. However, the existing facilities create barriers for children and families with mobility challenges, preventing full and safe use of this public space.

With this grant, the Village will be able to contract professional services, including engineering, architectural, and construction expertise, to design and deliver ADA-compliant bathrooms, safe pathways, and lifeguard facilities. These improvements will ensure that Lake Colby Beach is not only more inclusive for children with disabilities, but also safer and better equipped to serve the hundreds of local students who enjoy it each year.

Investing in the accessibility of Lake Colby Beach directly benefits the youth of Saranac Lake by expanding equitable access to recreation, supporting healthy lifestyles, and strengthening the connection between our schools, families, and community.

The Saranac Lake Central School District strongly supports this project and urges your favorable consideration of this application.

Sincerely,

Erika Bezio

Community School Liaison
Saranac Lake Central School District